

Figure 17.2 Tikka disease in groundnut leaves

Some species of fungi live as saprophytes. They grow upon the dead and decaying organic matters and get food from them. E.g. *Rhizopus.*

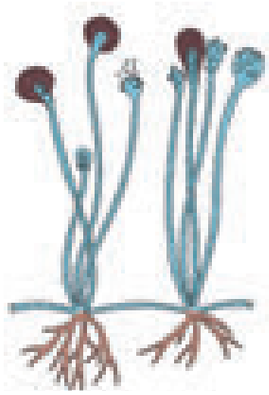
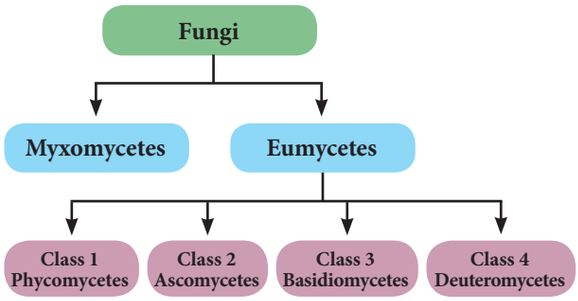


Figure 17.3 Rhizopus

Some species of fungi are living with algae and mutually benefitted. E.g. *Lichen.* Some of them live symbiotically with higher plants in their roots called *Mycorrhizae*

17.2.1 Classification of Fungi

Fungi are classified into different classes as given below.



17.2.2 Economic importance of Fungi

Fungi are useful to us in many ways. The importance of fungi are given below.

Antibiotic

Penicillin *(Penicillium notatum)* and Cephalosporin which cure different diseases are obtained from fungi.



Figure 17.4 *Penicillium notatum*

Food

Mushroom contains rich protein and minerals. The most common edible mushroom is *Agaricus* (Button mushroom).



Figure 17.5 Agaricus

Vitamins

Fungus like *Ashbya gospii* and *Eremothecium goshbyii)* are used to produce vitamin B_2 (riboflavin).

Alcohol

Fungus like yeast contain enzymes invertase and zymase, which ferment the sugar molasses into alcohol.

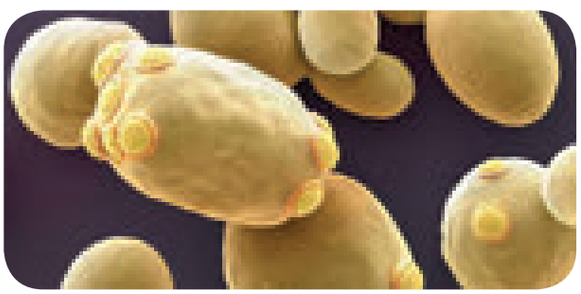


Figure 17.6 Yeast

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